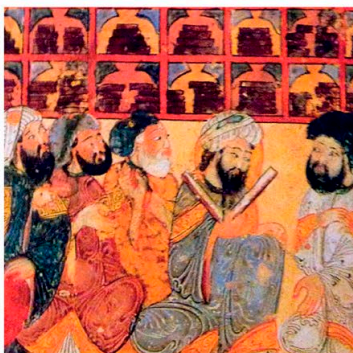


822 CE

BAYT AL-HIKMA (HOUSE OF WISDOM) FOUNDED

A centre for scholarship and, in particular, the translation of Latin and Greek texts into Arabic, the Bayt al-Hikma was established in Baghdad by Caliph al-Mamun. It hosted scholars such as the mathematician al-Khwarizmi, the “father of algebra”, and enabled Arab thinkers to have access to classical works of philosophy and science.



△ The House of Wisdom



810 CE

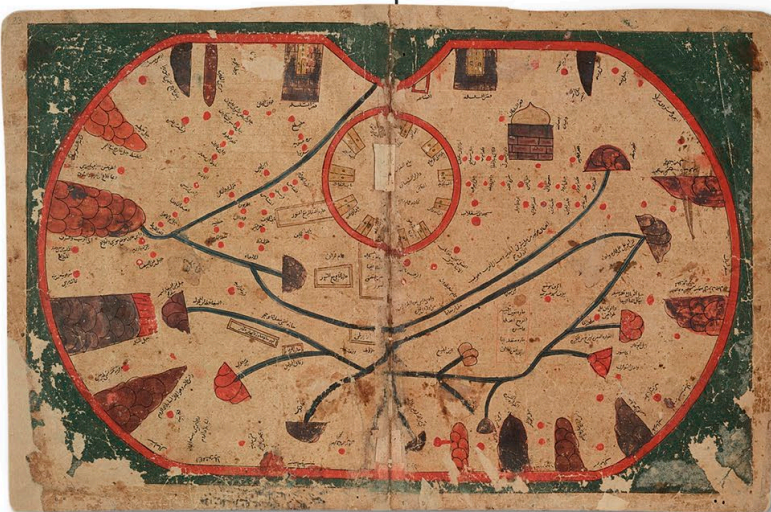
c. 811 CE The first paper money appears in China, where it is known as “flying money”

811 CE The Bulgarian Khan Krum defeats and kills the Byzantine emperor Nicephorus at Pliska, leading to an extension of the First Bulgarian Empire

831 CE

PALERMO FALLS

After the Sicilian city of Palermo was taken by Muslim Aghlabid forces, the Tunisian-based emirate came to dominate the entire island by 902 CE. Palermo prospered under the rule of Ziyadat Allah I (r. 817–38 CE) and his successors, becoming an important trading centre where Islamic, Byzantine, Jewish, and western Christian influences fused to create a rich hybrid culture that thrived until the 13th century.



△ Arabic map of Sicily